MED13 Foundation

MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

KEYNOTE INVITATION

We are looking for one voice to open our first evening

The MED13 Foundation is a first-year, family-led nonprofit working on a rare neurodevelopmental syndrome. On **Saturday, October 10, 2026** we host our first in-person evening in Palo Alto. We want someone whose work makes the case that rare disease research is worth beginning, because the right voice in this room is how a young foundation finds partners it will still have in ten years.

THE ASK

A 20 minute keynote on the evening of October 10

In person in Palo Alto or virtually.

WHO WILL BE LISTENING

Bay Area MED13 families
The families this work serves.

Researchers & clinicians
From our advisory boards: Mediator biology, stem-cell models, clinical genetics.

Local business & industry
Bay Area companies and biotech teams we are asking to stay with us past year one.

Funders & foundation peers
People who know how patient-led organizations get built, and can open the next door.

THE WEEKEND

FRIDAY, OCT 9 · ONLINE

Virtual Scientific Symposium

Convened by the MEDopathies Alliance with the MED13L and MED12 communities.

SATURDAY, OCT 10 · PALO ALTO

An Evening for Answers

Cocktail reception, a short family film, a live auction, and the keynote.

Amy Krystosik · Co-founder & President

partnerships@med13.org · med13.org/gala

A fiscally sponsored project of Rare Village, a 501(c)(3).

MED13 Foundation

MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

MEDopathies ALLIANCE

MED12 MED13 MED13L

2026 EVENT SPONSORSHIP PROSPECTUS

An Evening for Answers

The First Annual MED13 Foundation Gala

A cocktail evening in Palo Alto where the families living with MED13 syndrome and the scientists working to treat it stand in the same room. Your sponsorship funds the bridge between them.

WHEN	WHERE	SPONSORSHIP
Saturday, October 10, 2026	Palo Alto, California	$250 – $25,000

A LETTER FROM THE FOUNDERS

Why we are asking you to stand with us

Dear Partner,

Most families hear the words “MED13” for the first time in a genetics appointment, and then go home to a search engine that offers them a list of symptoms and nothing else. No treatment. No trial. No one to call. We know, because that is how our own family started.

In 2025 we founded the MED13 Foundation so that no family would have to begin there. In our first year we built a community of more than 125 families across 17 countries, enrolled families in a patient registry and a natural history study with COMBINEDBrain, and funded the first MED13 stem-cell lines, living models researchers can finally test treatments on.

On October 10, 2026 we are hosting our first gala, An Evening for Answers. It is a cocktail evening built to do one thing: put the people who fund the science, the researchers who do it, and the families who need it in the same room, and turn that evening into the next set of cell lines.

We are a first-year foundation, and we will be candid about that. Sponsorship underwrites the evening in full so that **every gift made in the room goes into research.** We have named exactly what each amount buys, down to a single sample.

We invite you to sponsor this first evening. Your name will sit alongside the scientists and families building the future of MED13 research, at the moment this community is being organized.

With gratitude,



Amy Krystosik, PhD, MPH
Co-founder & President
Arturo’s mom



Alvaro Alvarez Peralta
Co-founder & Chief Technology Officer
Arturo’s dad

Sponsors confirmed by **Friday, August 21, 2026** appear on every printed piece: the invitation, the program, the signage, and the photobooth backdrop that goes home in every guest’s camera roll. Family photographs and film are used with written, withdrawable consent from each family.

THE EVENING

Who you'll be in the room with

DATE
Sat, Oct 10, 2026

FORMAT
Cocktail reception

LOCATION
Palo Alto, CA

PART OF A TWO-DAY WEEKEND
Friday, Oct 9: the MEDopathies Alliance Virtual Scientific Symposium, online, with the MED13L and MED12 communities. Saturday, Oct 10: this evening, in person in Palo Alto.

YOUR AUDIENCE

Families & caregivers
Bay Area MED13 families joining us in person, plus our co-founder and her son Arturo.

Researchers
Scientists working on Mediator-complex biology, stem-cell models, and biomarkers.

Clinicians
Neurologists, geneticists, and developmental specialists who see these children.

Industry partners
Biotech and pharma teams evaluating rare neurodevelopmental programs.

Alliance leadership
Founders of the MEDopathies Alliance, our partners in cross-community research.

Bay Area community
Local business owners, donors, and advocates who show up for rare disease.

THE COMMUNITY YOUR NAME REACHES

125+
families in our community

17
countries they call home

9
advisors on our scientific & clinical boards

3
foundations in the Alliance

WHAT THE EVENING SETS IN MOTION

Gather
Families, researchers, and funders in one room.

→

Fund
Samples, multiomics, and iPSC cell lines.

→

Accelerate
Models researchers test real treatments on.

PARTNER WITH US

Sponsorship levels

Every level includes your name in the printed program and on med13.org. Benefits are cumulative. Each tier includes everything below it. All benefits apply to the October 10 evening; the Friday symposium is a non-commercial scientific program with no sponsor recognition.

PRESENTING SPONSOR · ONE AVAILABLE

$25,000

An Evening for Answers, presented by you

- → Top billing on every printed and digital piece for the evening
- → Remarks from the stage & podium recognition
- → Named in press and pre-event outreach
- → Introduce a speaker or the family film
- → Logo on the photobooth backdrop
- → A promotional table at the reception
- → Year-round logo placement on med13.org

LEAD SPONSOR — $10,000

- → Logo on event signage & the photobooth backdrop
- → Podium recognition from the stage
- → 8 tickets & a promotional table
- → Dedicated social post & website logo

CHAMPION SPONSOR — $5,000

- → Name one moment of the evening with signage
- → Podium mention
- → 6 tickets to the reception
- → Logo in the printed program

CATALYST SPONSOR — $2,500

- → Logo in the program and on event signage
- → 4 tickets to the reception
- → Shared social media recognition

PARTNER SPONSOR — $1,000

- → Name in the printed program
- → Name on the sponsor page at med13.org
- → 2 tickets to the reception

FAMILY CIRCLE · FOR INDIVIDUALS & SMALL BUSINESSES

$500 includes your name in the program and 2 tickets. **$250** name in the program, and you underwrite a MED13 family's seat at the table.

$500 / $250

Confirm by Friday, August 21, 2026 to appear on all printed materials and signage.

READY TO JOIN?

Sponsor a moment, or the whole evening

Prefer to attach your name to something specific? Each can be sponsored on its own, at any level, and carries named signage all evening.

Welcome Reception — $5,000

Named signage at the bar all evening, plus your logo on cocktail napkins as guests arrive.

Entertainment — $5,000

Named signage at the DJ booth and a live shout-out during the evening.

Dessert & Coffee — $2,500

Named signage at the dessert table during the closing remarks.

Family Film — $2,500

Underwrite the short film of MED13 families that screens during the program, with a credit on screen and from the podium.

Live Auction & Paddle Raise — $5,000

Named signage at the auction display, a credit on every bid card, and recognition from the podium as the paddles go up.

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

Sponsorship underwrites the evening in full, including venue, production, and the work of organizing and fundraising it, so that **every gift made in the room goes into research.** Our goal for the night is **$100,000**: six complete cell-line models, covering all four variant classes, with every gift matched dollar-for-dollar by our board up to a total of $10,000.

Two ways to commit

1. Email us at **partnerships@med13.org** with the level you have in mind, and we will send an agreement the same week.
2. Ask us for a 20-minute call and we will walk you through exactly what your level funds.

In-kind sponsorships are welcome too. Venue, catering, print, auction items, and photography all reduce the cost of the evening and count at the equivalent level.

TALK TO US

partnerships@med13.org

med13.org/gala

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

Thank you for standing with our families.

MED13 Foundation is a fiscally sponsored project of Rare Village, a 501(c)(3), EIN 83-4699994. Sponsorships are tax-deductible less the fair market value of goods received. · partnerships@med13.org

MED13 Foundation
MEMBER OF THE MEDOPATHIES ALLIANCE

MEDopathies ALLIANCE

COMPANION PACKET · 2026

Scientific Brief

The science your sponsorship funds, and the people doing it

MED13 syndrome is a rare neurodevelopmental disorder with no approved treatment. This brief covers what the MED13 Foundation has built since 2025: the registry, the natural history study, the biorepository, and the first stem-cell models. It also introduces the scientific advisory board guiding the work.

INSIDE
Impact to date

INSIDE
Scientific advisory board

INSIDE
Alliance & partnerships

THE SCIENCE

One molecular machine. Three diagnoses. No approved treatment.

The **Mediator complex** is the switchboard every cell uses to turn genes on and off during brain development. **MED13** encodes a subunit of its **CDK8 kinase module (CKM)**, tethering the kinase to core Mediator. Lose one working copy and the transcriptional programs that build a developing brain misfire.

THE CDK8 KINASE MODULE · FOUR REGULATORY SUBUNITS, THREE PATIENT COMMUNITIES

MED13 — 200+ families

ULTRA-RARE · AUTOSOMAL DOMINANT

Tethers the kinase module to core Mediator. MED13-related neurodevelopmental disorder.

MED12 — 200+ families

ULTRA-RARE · X-LINKED

Wraps CDK8–Cyclin C to activate the kinase. Opitz–Kaveggia/FG, Lujan–Fryns, Ohdo.
MED12L completes the module but has no patient community yet.

MED13L — 720+ families

1.5–6 / 100K BIRTHS

Paralog of MED13, in the same structural position.

Losing any one subunit disrupts the same transcriptional programs. That is the basis for the shared clinical features, and the reason the three can be pursued for shared trial readiness under one master protocol.

SHARED CLINICAL FEATURES ACROSS ALL THREE

- Intellectual disability
- Speech & language delay
- Hypotonia
- Seizures / epilepsy
- Cardiac defects
- Behavioral features

WHERE A TREATMENT COULD COME FROM

Gene activation & restoration

All three are candidate dosage-sensitive disorders, and MED13L includes well-documented dosage loss. Assigning a mechanism class variant by variant is the first objective. CRISPRa has rescued SCN2A haploinsufficiency in mouse and human neurons (Ahituv, *Nature* 2025;646:983).

RNA-based therapies

Antisense oligonucleotides are being explored to raise MED13 expression, and mRNA-stabilizing small molecules are gene-agnostic in principle. One screening infrastructure serves all three.

Drug repurposing

MED13L proteomics revealed an immune-dysregulation signature. If shared across MED13, one repurposed anti-inflammatory could be tested under a single protocol.

Clinical biomarkers

A plasma immune panel reported in MED13L is a candidate we propose to test across all three. A pan-CKM panel would enable shared trial endpoints.

WHAT MED13 HAS BUILT

51
families in the Simons Searchlight registry

9
families in our natural history study & biorepository, with COMBINEDBrain

2
iPSC stem-cell lines reprogrammed from MED13 children

EEG
longitudinal recordings banked via COMBINEDBrain

WHY NOW

Structural studies now resolve CKM architecture at near-atomic resolution, confirming MED12, MED13, and MED13L variants disrupt the same interfaces. The FDA's 2026 **draft Plausible Mechanism** framework proposes a pathway for mechanistically related variants to be evaluated together under one master protocol, on a known-cause criterion that is why mechanism-class work matters. The infrastructure is in place. What is missing is cell models for enough children to make the cohort real.

Reference: Iyer S et al., *Int. J. Mol. Sci.* 2026;27(5):2221. Counts current as of July 2026 and grow with every newly sequenced child.

THE DAY BEFORE

Our First MEDopathies Scientific Symposium

On **Friday, October 9**, the day before the gala, we convene the first Virtual Scientific Symposium of the MEDopathies Alliance with the MED12 and MED13L foundations.

5 hrs
Two sessions, 10:00 to 16:00 Pacific, on Zoom

3
Foundations convening as one Alliance

CC BY
Science sessions published openly

CONFIRMED

- **Kuang-Lei Tsai, PhD**
  UTHealth Houston
  Opening keynote. Cryo-EM of the human Mediator kinase module and its structural target landscape.
- **P.J. Brooks, PhD**
  NIH / NCATS
  Keynote on federal rare disease research infrastructure and how ultra-rare programs get built.
- **Ryan L. Boudreau, PhD**
  University of Iowa
  RNA-based control of gene dosage: antisense oligonucleotides and AAV-delivered gene modulation.
- **Carla Marini, MD, PhD**
  Ospedali Riuniti Marche
  Natural history, phenotype, and cohort readiness. Also on our clinical advisory board.
- **Terry Jo Bichell, PhD, MPH**
  COMBINEDBrain
  Moderates the cohort-readiness session.
- **Dylan Taatjes, PhD**
  University of Colorado Boulder
  Introduces the keynote and moderates the model-systems panel.
- **Nadav Ahituv, PhD**
  UCSF
  CRISPR activation and cis-regulation therapy, including CRISPRa rescue of SCN2A haploinsufficiency.
- **Maya Arce, PhD**
  Arc Institute
  MED12 as a transcriptional coordinator, and what CRISPR screening in primary human cells reveals.
- **Ze-Xuan Li**
  UC Santa Cruz
  Mouse models. MED13 and cortical radial migration via PlxnA4, published in Communications Biology.
- **Jean Chia, MD**
  Stanford Medicine Children's Health
  Moderates the cross-foundation family panel.

PROGRAM IN DRAFT. AGENDA LOCKS AUGUST 21, 2026

The partners are lined up. The cell lines are the bottleneck.

Two research groups have committed major work to MED13 **in kind**, at no cost to the Foundation. Neither can produce an answer without patient-derived cell models to run against. That is what a gift tonight buys, and it is the single step nobody will donate for us.

THREE LINES OF EVIDENCE, TRIANGULATED

1 IN KIND

Perturb-seq screens

Pooled CRISPR perturbation with single-cell readout, ranking which MED13 variants actually disrupt function, and which to prioritize for everything downstream.

2 FUNDED TONIGHT

iPSC models + multiomics

MED13 Foundation biorepository

Patient-derived stem cells and neurons from our own children, with full multiomic readout. Two lines exist; tonight funds the rest of the four-class panel. The only human-cell system where a candidate therapy can be tested.

3 IN KIND

Variant-specific mouse models

Whole-organism validation for drug repurposing and future ASO development, built on the variants the screens prioritise.

No single model tells the truth on its own. A hit in a screen means little until it holds in a human neuron and again in an animal. Three independent readouts converging on the same variant is what makes a therapeutic hypothesis worth a trial.

THE FOUR VARIANT CLASSES UNDER COMPARISON

p.830–835
Recurrent hotspot in MED13 protein

p.326–330
Phosphodegron region

Truncating
Loss of function

Other missense
Comparison arm

THE ORDER OF WORK

Screen
Perturb-seq ranks the variants

→

Build
Cell lines and mouse models on the priority variants

→

Test
Repurposed drugs, then ASOs

Partner commitments are in-kind and subject to scheduling. Variant priorities follow the screening data.

Funding the bridge from diagnosis to discovery

For the 200-plus children identified with MED13 syndrome, diagnosis is where the road currently ends. Every gift tonight funds a real, concrete step in the research pipeline: from a single sample to a living cell model that allows researchers to test treatments.

TONIGHT'S ASK, BY WHAT IT FUNDS

Collect a Sample
Collection & biobanking for one more child
$1,000

Read the Biology
Multiomic analysis of one child's sample
$2,000

Reprogram a Line
An iPSC stem-cell line, ready to test therapies on
$13,000

FULL JOURNEY
Build a Complete Model
Sample → full multiomic readout → living cell line
$16,000

TONIGHT'S GOAL
Six complete models covering all four variant classes, with two to spare. Exclusive of the match.
$100,000

Every gift matched dollar-for-dollar by our board, up to a total of $10,000.

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IMPACT TO DATE

Founded in 2025, building with urgency

200+
Children diagnosed worldwide

125+
Active families in our community

51
Families enrolled in the Simons Searchlight patient registry

17
Countries our families call home

9
Families enrolled in our natural history study and biorepository, built with COMBINEDBrain

2
iPSC stem-cell lines reprogrammed

35
Families joining our monthly meetups

2
Regional family ambassadors

CROSS-COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

The MED13 Foundation is a member of the **MEDopathies Alliance**, standing with the MED13L and MED12 communities to convene a Virtual Scientific Symposium (Oct 9, 2026), a research workshop in Denver (Dec 2026), and The Meeting of the MEDs (2027).



"Diagnosed at one. Still no treatment. You can help the science catch up to our son."
Amy, Arturo's mom and MED13 Foundation co-founder

SCIENTIFIC ADVISORY BOARD

Guided by researchers at the front lines of MED13 science

Six scientists advise our research strategy, from the biochemistry and structure of the Mediator complex itself to the data infrastructure that makes a rare diagnosis findable. Three clinicians sit on our clinical advisory board, for nine advisors in all.



Dylan Taatjes, PhD

UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO BOULDER

Biochemist whose lab helped define how the Mediator complex and its CDK8 kinase module switch genes on and off. That is the core biology MED13 sits inside.



Kuang-Lei Tsai, PhD

MCGOVERN MEDICAL SCHOOL, UTHEALTH HOUSTON

Structural biologist using cryo-electron microscopy to map the architecture of the Mediator complex, revealing how MED13 fits into the machine and what breaks when it is lost.



Katrina Cooper, PhD

ROWAN UNIVERSITY

Studies the Cyclin C–MED13 relationship at the molecular root of the syndrome, working out how changes in MED13 disrupt the wiring of the developing brain.



Alicia Campbell, PhD

ROWAN UNIVERSITY

Works with Dr. Cooper on Cyclin C–MED13 mechanisms, investigating how the syndrome plays out at the molecular level and what that points to for future therapies.



Melissa Haendel, PhD

TISLAB, UNC · MONARCH INITIATIVE

Director of precision health & translational informatics at UNC and co-founder of the Monarch Initiative. She builds the data and ontology infrastructure that helps rare diagnoses get recognized, studied, and linked to mechanism.



Katja Brose, PhD

LARK SCIENCE ADVISORS · FORMERLY CZI & NEURON

Neuroscientist and scientific strategist with 25+ years launching initiatives that accelerate research. Editor-in-Chief of *Neuron* during 17 years at Cell Press, then Neuroscience Program Lead at the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative, where she built the Neurodegeneration Challenge Network and helped fund the Patient-Partnered Collaborations program.

Clinical advisory board

Pediatric neurologists and clinical geneticists who diagnose MED13 syndrome, collect the samples our research depends on, and author the reference literature other clinicians rely on.



Carla Marini, MD, PhD

OSPEDALI RIUNITI MARCHE, ANCONA (ITALY)

Internationally recognized pediatric neurologist and expert in epilepsy and neurogenetics. She earned her PhD at the University of Melbourne under Prof. Samuel Berkovic, has authored more than 300 publications (H-index 66), and directs the Pediatric Neuropsychiatry Unit at Salesi Children's Hospital. She is collecting MED13 samples and co-authoring the MED13 GeneReview.



Angelica Delgado-Vega, MD, PhD

KAROLINSKA INSTITUTE

Clinical geneticist focused on rare neurodevelopmental syndromes, and co-investigator on our grant-funded research applications. She is co-authoring the MED13 GeneReview, the reference clinicians worldwide will turn to at the moment of diagnosis.



Ann Nordgren, MD, PhD

KAROLINSKA INSTITUTE

Clinical geneticist whose rare-disease research helps put a name, and a mechanism, to conditions that have long gone undiagnosed. She is a collaborator on our funded research program.